# “Everyone at church has it all together but me.”

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## Where it often comes from

On Sunday morning people arrive in nice clothes, smiling, with children in order and answers ready. We see their best and compare it with our worst. Church culture can also reward looking fine, so struggles stay hidden and everyone concludes that they alone are failing.

## What Scripture teaches

Paul writes plainly, “All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God,” and John says, “If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.” Paul also says, “We have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us.” Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.” The church is not a gathering of finished people. It is a gathering of forgiven people who are still being changed, and many of them are hurting more than they show.

> *“For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God”* (Romans 3:23).

## Also see

> “If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us” (1 John 1:8).

> “Now we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us” (2 Corinthians 4:7).

> “Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail” (James 5:16).

> “Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’” (Luke 5:31).

## Common self-statements

- They have no problems.
- I am the only one who is struggling.
- Everyone else is more spiritual.
- If I show my struggles, I will not belong.
- I must be failing as a Christian.
- Their lives are perfect.

## Common logical errors

- Social comparison: Comparing my private struggles with their public image.
- Mind reading: Assuming that they have no problems.
- Mental filter: Focusing on what looks good and missing hidden pain.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling inadequate and concluding that I am.

## Challenging questions

- How much do I actually know about the lives of people at church?
- What do I show to others at church, and what do I hide?
- If someone else hid struggles as I do, what would that mean about them?

- What does Scripture say about the condition of all believers?
- What would happen if one person were honest?
- Who might also be struggling and need to hear that I am?

## Truth summary

> No one at church has it all together. We are all forgiven sinners, treasures in jars of clay. My struggles do not disqualify me, and honesty can free others as well as myself.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hypocritical
- Church
- Pride
- Confession
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

**Broken Things** — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

**Worn** — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

**This Is Amazing Grace** — Phil Wickham
Christ bears the burden of rescue rather than demanding self-salvation.

**Amazing Grace** — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

# My Plan for Replacing "Everyone at church has it all together but me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"Everyone at church has it all together but me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What do I hide at church?
- ☐ What do I really know about them?
- ☐ Who might be struggling too?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about all of us?
- ☐ Who can I be honest with?
- ☐ What would honesty do?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ All have sinned, including those who look fine.
- ☐ The church is for the sick, not the perfect.
- ☐ We are jars of clay.
- ☐ Honesty invites healing.
- ☐ My struggle is common.
- ☐ I belong among imperfect people.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Romans 3:23
  *"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God."*
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:7
  *"Now we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us."*
- ☐ Luke 5:31
  *"Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Honesty and welcome: Each week, note one moment of honesty at church and how it was received.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Romans 3:23 becomes: "Sarah can write: "All of us fall short, and Christ welcomes all of us.""*
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Church" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- ☐ Ask yourself what is hidden. List what you hide at church and why.
- ☐ Share a small struggle. Tell one trusted believer something real.
- ☐ Listen for others. Ask someone "How are you really doing?"
- ☐ Read 2 Corinthians 4:7. Remember that cracks let the light through.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Everyone at church has it all together but me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | An honest moment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone at church has it all together but me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Father, I have compared my inside to everyone else's outside. Thank You that Your church is for sinners. Give me courage to be real and compassion for others who are hurting too. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*